

The Corbiani Almanac

MARCH 8 - 14, 2026

Every Star Has Her Stage Crew

 Elsie's No-Go List: Mushrooms

Week at a Glance

DAY	EVENTS	DINNER	ALBUM
Sunday 03/08 CLOUDY	—	Pulled Pork Picnic with Cole Slaw on Taco Shells	Anderson .Paak — Malibu
Monday 03/09 CLEAR	SCS Planning Office Hours; MTP Sovereign Clouds Managers Meeting; 🗨️ YAT Tech Week (Elsie rehearsal); ⚠️ IDP Check-in (conflicts with YAT pickup)	Chickpea & Broccoli Curry over Rice	Altin Gun — Yol
Tuesday 03/10 SUNNY	1:1 Luis; 1:1 Robyn; 🗨️ YAT Tech Week — be at RCC by 4:30; 🏊 Level 4 Swim Lessons (Elsie)	Babo Pasta with Alfredo Sauce	Parcels — Day/Night
Wednesday 03/11 SUNNY	✈️ Laura departs for Portland; 🗨️ YAT Tech Week (Dan pickup)	One-Pan Chicken Broccoli Couscous	Masego — Masego
Thursday 03/12 SUNNY	🗨️ YAT Tech Week (Dan pickup)	American Tacos with Costco Taco Seasoning	Black Pumas — Black Pumas
Friday 03/13 OVERCAST	🗨️ YAT Tech Week — final rehearsal (Dan pickup)	Mac & Cheese with Broccoli	Tank and the Bangas — Green Balloon
Saturday 03/14 OVERCAST	✈️ Laura returns from Portland; 🗨️ Elsie's YAT Play — SHOWTIME! ☀️; 🍕 Pizza celebration dinner	Pizza after Elsie's YAT Play	Ezra Collective — Where I'm Meant to Be

Daily Plan

Seven days of dinner, music, and good company

Sunday, March 8

The week begins with a warm drizzly Sunday and the whole family together — Laura, Dan, and Elsie around one table for the last time before Wednesday's departure. Pulled pork has been slow-cooking all day, filling the house with smoky sweetness. Anderson .Paak's Malibu spins in the background, sun-soaked even when the sky isn't. Tonight is about savoring the calm before the busy week ahead — tech week starts tomorrow, and everything accelerates from here.

Pulled Pork Picnic with Cole Slaw on Taco Shells

AMERICAN BBQ

Slow-cooked pulled pork with tangy cole slaw served on crispy taco shells — a picnic-style dinner that's equal parts comfort and crunch

pork shoulder, brown sugar, smoked paprika, cole slaw, taco shells

AT THE TABLE

This pulled pork has been cooking low and slow all day, just quietly getting ready. What's something YOU've been working on slowly that you're almost ready to show people?

Connects the slow-cooking metaphor to Elsie's own preparation for Saturday's performance. Lets her name what she's been building toward, which strengthens her sense of competence and anticipation. At 8, kids are learning to recognize their own growth — this question holds up a mirror.

SELF-MASTERY

The Art of Preparation

The people who perform at the highest level aren't the most talented — they're the ones who treat preparation as the main event.

"To the extent that we believe we can skip steps, avoid the process, magically gain power through political connections or easy formulas, or depend on our natural talents, we move against this grain and reverse our natural powers."

— Robert Greene, *Mastery* Ch. 1

The Axe and the Tree

Abraham Lincoln reportedly said, "Give me six hours to chop down a tree and I will spend the first four sharpening the axe." Whether he actually said it is debatable, but the image sticks because it violates our instincts. Four hours sharpening? Most of us would be at the trunk in five minutes, sweating and swinging, convinced that effort equals progress. This is the gap Robert Greene identifies in **Mastery** — the distance between what we do (start hacking) and what masters do (prepare until the work itself becomes almost effortless). Greene studied hundreds of historical figures — Darwin, Leonardo, Edison — and found the same pattern: the ones who achieved extraordinary results spent an almost absurd amount of time in preparation. Not planning in the abstract sense, but a specific kind of deep immersion Greene calls the Apprenticeship Phase, where you observe, practice, and experiment before you ever try to perform. "This intense connection and desire allows them to withstand the pain of the process — the self-doubts, the tedious hours of practice and study, the inevitable setbacks," Greene writes (**Mastery**, Ch. 1). The preparation **is** the work. The performance is just its echo. Edison didn't stumble into the lightbulb — he prepared through thousands of failed experiments, each one narrowing the path to the one that worked.

This week, preparation isn't abstract for your family — it's the operating reality. Laura is preparing for Portland, packing not just clothes but the mental architecture of being away: the lists, the check-ins, the trust that things will hold. Dan is preparing to solo-parent, which means front-loading decisions — meals planned, logistics mapped, backup plans sketched — so the days themselves can flow instead of fracture. And Elsie is deep in tech week, where the magic of Saturday's performance is being built one lighting cue, one blocking note, one run-through at a time. None of them will feel entirely ready. That's the point Greene makes: preparation doesn't eliminate uncertainty, it gives you a foundation sturdy enough to absorb it. The tree falls not because of the final swing, but because of the four hours that came before. What part of your week could use more sharpening before the swing?

"This intense connection and desire allows them to withstand the pain of the process — the self-doubts, the tedious hours of practice and study, the inevitable setbacks."

— Robert Greene, *Mastery* Ch. 1

Reflect: What part of your week could use more sharpening before the swing?

RECIPETEACHER · 6-8 SERVINGS · PREP 15 MIN · COOK 8 HOURS (SLOW COOKER)

MAMMA KAREN SAYS

Listen here, honey. You rub that pork shoulder like you mean it. Brown sugar, smoked paprika, chili powder, garlic powder, salt, pepper. Every inch. Put it in the slow cooker, set it to low, and walk away for eight hours. When it's done, the meat should fall apart if you even look at it. Shred it with two forks, toss it back in those juices, and pile it high on your taco shells. The slaw goes on top. Cabbage, carrots, a little vinegar, a pinch of sugar, and some mayo. If you skip the slaw, you're eating dry pork in a shell and that's not a meal, that's a punishment.

HOW IT COMES TOGETHER

A · MIX RUB, MASSAGE ALL OVER PORK

- 3-4 lb pork shoulder (butt) (*patted dry*)
- 2 Tbs brown sugar
- 1 Tbs smoked paprika
- 1 Tbs chili powder
- 1 tsp garlic powder
- 1 tsp salt
- 1 tsp black pepper
- 1 tsp dry mustard

B · PLACE IN SLOW COOKER BOTTOM

- 1/2 cup chicken broth
- 1 onion (*quartered*)

C · TOSS TOGETHER, CHILL UNTIL SERVING

- 3 cups green cabbage (*shredded thin*)
- 1 cup carrots (*grated*)
- 1/3 cup mayonnaise
- 1 Tbs apple cider vinegar
- 1 tsp sugar
- pinch salt and pepper

Final: place rubbed pork on onions in slow cooker → cook LOW 8 hrs until fork-tender → shred with two forks, toss in juices → pile pork on taco shells, top with slaw

VARIATIONS

Korean Gochujang Pulled Pork — Replace the dry rub with a gochujang, soy sauce, sesame oil, and honey glaze fo... (recipe)

Carolina Vinegar Pulled Pork — Skip the dry rub sweetness and finish with a tangy vinegar, red pepper flake, a... (recipe)

Hawaiian Kalua Pulled Pork — Use just sea salt and liquid smoke for a smoky island-style pork, serve on Hawa... (recipe)

CHEF'S TIPS

SAUCE Carolina-Style Apple Cider Finishing Sauce — A vinegar-forward finishing sauce tossed with the shredded pork to brighten the richness and prevent the meat from tasting one-note sweet. Mix 2 tbsp apple cider vinegar, 1 tbsp brown sugar, 1 tsp sm...

ACID Quick-Pickled Red Onions — Bright pink, tangy, crunchy pickled onion rings that cut through the richness of the pork and add visual pop to the taco shells. Thin-slice 1 red onion. Cover with 1/2 cup apple cider vinegar, 1 tbsp...

TEMPERATURE Ice-Cold Buttermilk Slaw — A tangy, creamy slaw dressed with buttermilk instead of straight mayo — kept ice-cold until the moment it hits the hot pork. Whisk 1/4 cup buttermilk, 2 tbsp mayo, 1 tbsp apple cider vinegar, 1 tsp h...

PREPARATION Smoked Paprika Butter-Toasted Shells — Brush taco shells with butter and smoked paprika before toasting for deeper flavor and extra crispness. Melt 1 tbsp butter + 1/2 tsp smoked paprika. Brush inside of shells. Toast at 375°F for 3-4 minutes.

ANDERSON . PAAK

Malibu

2016 · ·

The album that turned Anderson .Paak from a backing musician into a global star. Malibu is a kaleidoscopic ride through...

Paak's sun-drenched California soul is the soundtrack to a lazy Sunday picnic. The warm, organic production matches the smoky pulled pork energy.

LISTEN ON SPOTIFY

Monday, March 9

3:05–3:30	SCS PLANNING OFFICE HOURS
3:35–4:00	MTP SOVEREIGN CLOUDS MANAGERS MEETING
4:00–7:00	 YAT TECH WEEK (ELSIE REHEARSAL)
4:10–5:00	 IDP CHECK-IN (CONFLICTS WITH YAT PICKUP)

Tech week begins! Elsie heads to YAT for her first 4–7 PM rehearsal, and the household shifts into a new rhythm. It’s a gorgeous sunny day — 73°F and clear — perfect for the warm spices of tonight’s chickpea curry. Altin Gün’s Turkish psych-folk fills the kitchen while the cumin seeds pop in coconut oil. Dan has a scheduling conflict: IDP Check-in overlaps with YAT pickup at 4:10.

Chickpea & Broccoli Curry over Rice

INDIAN

A warming coconut milk curry with chickpeas, broccoli, and garam masala served over steamed rice

chickpeas, broccoli, coconut milk, curry spices, basmati rice

AT THE TABLE

Tech week started today! What’s one thing your director or a crew member did that most people in the audience will never know about?

Draws attention to behind-the-scenes contributions — the stagehands, the costume helper, the kid who moves the props. This builds gratitude and connects directly to the weekly story about the school janitor. At 8, kids are developing moral reasoning about fairness and recognition; noticing invisible labor is a powerful lesson.

The Shortcut Trap

Charlie Munger has a deceptively simple rule for avoiding catastrophic mistakes: "Invert, always invert." Instead of asking how to succeed, ask how you'd guarantee failure, then don't do those things. Applied to preparation, the inversion is revealing. How do you guarantee you'll fumble a big week? Easy: wing it. Trust that you'll figure it out in the moment. Assume the information you need will appear when you need it. Skip the rehearsal. Don't make the list. Munger spent decades watching people — brilliant people, capable people — destroy good outcomes through sloppy preparation. Not because they didn't care, but because they confused being smart with being ready. "It is remarkable how much long-term advantage people like us have gotten by trying to be consistently not stupid, instead of trying to be very intelligent," Munger said at a Berkshire Hathaway shareholders' meeting. The distinction matters: intelligence is about having the answer; preparation is about having done the work so the answer can surface when pressure arrives.

Think about the last time something went sideways in your household. The forgotten permission slip. The dinner that devolved into cereal because nobody thawed the chicken. The morning where everyone was late because shoes couldn't be found. These aren't intelligence failures — everyone in your house is sharp enough to handle these things. They're preparation failures, tiny ones that compound. Munger calls this cascading effect "the lollapalooza" — small errors that snowball because each one makes the next more likely. The kid is late to school, which means you're late to work, which means you skip lunch to catch up, which means you're irritable at pickup. The antidote isn't superhuman planning. It's what Munger would call a checklist: a simple, boring, unglamorous tool that externalizes decisions you've already made. Pilots use them. Surgeons use them. Solo parents during tech week should probably use them too. The checklist doesn't insult your intelligence — it respects the reality that your brain, no matter how capable, has limited bandwidth when it's managing a household, a career, and an eight-year-old's costume changes. What's one thing you could put on a checklist today that would prevent a predictable problem later this week?

"It is remarkable how much long-term advantage people like us have gotten by trying to be consistently not stupid, instead of trying to be very intelligent."

— Charlie Munger, Berkshire Hathaway Shareholders' Meeting

Reflect: What's one thing you could put on a checklist today that would prevent a predictable problem later this week?

VEGAN COCOTTE · 4 SERVINGS · PREP 10 MIN · COOK 30 MIN

MAMMA KAREN SAYS

Heat the coconut oil in your big pan. Medium heat. Onions go in first until they're soft and sweet. Then garlic, ginger, and that little chili pepper if you're brave. Stir in your spices, cumin, coriander, chili powder, turmeric, and let them toast for one minute, no more. Tomato paste, then the whole can of coconut milk, stir it smooth. In go the broccoli and chickpeas, push them under the sauce. Simmer ten minutes until the broccoli still has some fight in it. Finish with coconut cream and cilantro. Anyone who says broccoli is boring just hasn't met this curry.

HOW IT COMES TOGETHER

A · SAUTE ONION 3-5 MIN, ADD GARLIC/GINGER/CHILI 1 MIN

- 1 Tbs coconut oil
- 1 medium onion (*diced*)
- 2 cloves garlic (*minced*)
- 1 Tbs fresh ginger (*finely chopped*)
- 1/4 red chili pepper (*finely chopped*)

B · STIR SPICES 1 MIN, ADD PASTE AND MILK, SIMMER

- 1 tsp ground cumin
- 1 tsp ground coriander
- 1/2 tsp chili powder
- 1/2 tsp turmeric
- 2 Tbs tomato paste
- 14 oz can coconut milk

C · ADD BROCCOLI AND CHICKPEAS, SIMMER 10 MIN

- 1 lb broccoli florets (*cut small*)
- 14 oz can chickpeas (*drained and rinsed*)
- 1/2 cup coconut cream
- handful fresh cilantro (*roughly chopped*)

Final: stir in coconut cream and cilantro → season with salt to taste → serve over steamed rice

VARIATIONS

Thai Coconut Chickpea Curry — Swap the Indian spices for Thai red curry paste, add bamboo shoots and basil for... (recipe)

Curried Chickpeas with Spinach — Drop the broccoli and add spinach with extra tomato sauce for a more traditional... (recipe)

Japanese Curry with Chickpeas and Vegetables — Use Japanese curry roux blocks instead of individual spices for a sweeter, thicker... (recipe)

CHEF'S TIPS

PREPARATION Bloom the Spices in Coconut Oil — Toast garam masala and cumin seeds in coconut oil before adding any other ingredients to unlock fat-soluble flavor compounds. Heat 1 tbsp coconut oil, add 1/2 tsp cumin seeds until they pop (30 sec),...

SAUCE Cool Lime Crema — A cold, tangy crema dolloped onto each bowl of hot curry — the temperature and acid contrast transforms the dish. Mix 3 tbsp sour cream or yogurt, juice of 1/2 lime, pinch of salt. Dollop on each hot...

TEXTURE Toasted Coconut Flake Garnish — Golden, nutty coconut flakes scattered over each bowl add a crunch layer that the creamy curry desperately needs. Toast 1/3 cup unsweetened coconut flakes in a dry skillet, stirring constantly, 2-3 m...

ACID Lime and Cilantro Shower — A squeeze of fresh lime and a shower of torn cilantro right before serving lifts the entire dish from rich and heavy to rich and vibrant. Squeeze 1/2 lime over the finished curry. Tear cilantro leaves...

ALTIN GUN

Yol

2021 · ·

Amsterdam-based Turkish psych-folk band whose infectious grooves have made them festival favorites worldwide. Yol blend...

The spice-forward curry calls for music with equally rich cultural depth. Altin Gun's Anatolian melodies meet funky grooves — a cross-cultural conversation at the dinner table.

LISTEN ON SPOTIFY

Tuesday, March 10

2:50–3:10	1:1 LUIS
3:10–3:30	1:1 ROBYN
4:00–7:00	 YAT TECH WEEK — BE AT RCC BY 4:30
6:00–6:30	 LEVEL 4 SWIM LESSONS (ELSIE)

The warmest day of the week at 77°F, and the last dinner with all three of us before Laura flies to Portland tomorrow. Tonight calls for something special: Babo Pasta, the family original, with hand-rolled spinach egg-yolk fettuccine and alfredo sauce made the right way — finished in the pan, not poured on the plate. Parcels’ disco-funk sophistication matches the occasion. This is the night to linger at the table.

Babo Pasta with Alfredo Sauce

ITALIAN

Homemade spinach pasta with rich egg yolks and a classic alfredo sauce — a family original worth treating with respect

egg yolks, spinach, flour, butter, cream, parmesan

AT THE TABLE

This is our last dinner all three of us before Mom flies to Portland. If you could give Mom one thing to carry in her suitcase that would remind her of us — not clothes, something more like a feeling or a memory — what would you pack for her?

Tuesday is the emotional pivot of the week — the last full-family dinner before Laura leaves. This question lets Elsie process the upcoming separation through imagination rather than anxiety. Naming a feeling or memory she'd 'pack' builds emotional vocabulary and gives the family a sweet shared moment before the shift.

The Three Modes of Learning

Robert Greene breaks the Apprenticeship Phase into three distinct modes, and the sequence matters more than most people realize. First comes Deep Observation — the Passive Mode. You enter a new situation and your only job is to watch. Not to impress, not to contribute, not to prove yourself. Just watch. How do things actually work here? What are the unwritten rules? Who holds the real influence? Greene is emphatic about this in **Mastery**, Ch. 2: "Do not make the mistake of imagining you must get attention, impress people, or prove yourself in this stage." It's counterintuitive, especially in a culture that rewards hustle and visibility. But Greene argues that the people who skip observation — who jump straight into action — build their skills on a shaky foundation. They don't understand the terrain they're operating in. Think about Elsie this week in tech rehearsals. Before she can nail her blocking, she needs to observe: where does the light hit? When does the music cue? What's the director actually asking for versus what she thinks is being asked?

The second mode is Skills Acquisition — the Practice Mode. This is the grinding part, the repetition that nobody wants to film a montage of. "It is essential that you begin with one skill that you can master, and that serves as a foundation for acquiring others," Greene writes (**Mastery**, Ch. 2). One skill. Not seven. Not a scattered attempt to improve everything at once. For Dan this week, that one foundational skill might be the evening routine — nailing the sequence from dinner through bedtime so tightly that it runs on rhythm rather than willpower. The third mode is Experimentation — the Active Mode. Once you've observed and practiced, you earn the right to improvise. This is where real confidence lives, built on the knowledge that you've done enough groundwork to handle surprises. Laura in Portland will cycle through all three in days: observing a new team's dynamics, practicing her presentation, then experimenting in real time when the questions start flying. Which mode are you in right now — and are you trying to skip ahead to one you haven't earned yet?

"Do not make the mistake of imagining you must get attention, impress people, or prove yourself in this stage."

— Robert Greene, *Mastery* Ch. 2

Reflect: Which of Greene's three modes — observation, practice, or experimentation — are you in right now, and are you trying to skip ahead?

BELLY FULL (ALFREDO BASE) · 4 SERVINGS · PREP 30 MIN (PASTA) + 5 MIN (SAUCE) · COOK 15 MIN

MAMMA KAREN SAYS

This is Babo's pasta, so pay attention. Spinach goes in the food processor until it's smooth. Make a well of flour on the counter. Egg yolks only, no whites, and that spinach puree go in the middle. Work it together with your hands until it's a smooth green dough, then let it rest. Roll it thin, cut it how you like it. For the sauce, melt butter, pour in the cream, let it warm up gentle. Parmesan goes in off the heat, a little at a time, stirring always. This is not hard. If it breaks, your heat was too high and I told you to keep it low.

HOW IT COMES TOGETHER

A · WELL METHOD: YOLKS AND SPINACH PUREE IN FLOUR WELL, KNEAD 8-10 MIN, REST 30 MIN

- 2 cups all-purpose flour (or 00) (*mounded on counter*)
- 4 large egg yolks
- 2 cups packed fresh spinach (*pureed smooth with 1 Tbs water*)
- pinch salt

B · MELT BUTTER, ADD CREAM, SIMMER 5 MIN, REMOVE FROM HEAT, STIR IN CHEESE

- 1/2 cup unsalted butter
- 2 cups heavy cream
- 1.5 cups Parmigiano-Reggiano (*freshly grated*)
- pinch nutmeg (*freshly grated*)
- to taste salt and white pepper

Final: roll pasta thin, cut into fettuccine or pappardelle → boil in salted water 2-3 min (fresh cooks fast) → toss pasta in Alfredo sauce with splash of pasta water → serve immediately with extra Parmesan

VARIATIONS

Pesto Spinach Alfredo — Stir 2 tablespoons of basil pesto into the Alfredo sauce for a vibrant, herby g...
(recipe)

Lemon Cream Pasta — Add lemon zest and juice to the Alfredo for a bright, citrusy twist that cuts t... (recipe)

Roasted Garlic Alfredo — Roast a whole head of garlic until soft and sweet, mash it into the butter befo...
(recipe)

CHEF'S TIPS

PREPARATION The Pasta Water Emulsion — Reserve starchy pasta cooking water and use it to build a silky, clingy sauce instead of a heavy cream puddle. Reserve 1 cup pasta water before draining. Off heat, add cheese in handfuls alternating ...

ACID Lemon Zest and Nutmeg Whisper — Two secret ingredients that make every great alfredo taste more complex without anyone identifying them. Microplane the zest of 1 lemon and 4-5 passes of whole nutmeg into the finished sauce. Stir gently.

TEXTURE Garlic Butter Panko Crown — A golden, crunchy breadcrumb topping that provides the textural contrast a creamy pasta desperately needs. Melt 1 tbsp butter, add 1 minced garlic clove (30 sec), add 1/4 cup panko (2-3 min until gol...

PREPARATION Finish in the Pan, Not on the Plate — Transfer pasta into the sauce pan and toss — never pour sauce over drained pasta on a plate. Use tongs to transfer pasta into sauce pan. Toss 60 seconds over low heat, adding pasta water splashes. Se...

PARCELS

Day/Night

2021 · ·

This double album from the Australian-German disco-funk outfit is a love letter to sophisticated pop music. Produced wi...

Homemade pasta deserves sophisticated accompaniment. Parcels' pristine musicianship and silky harmonies are the musical equivalent of fresh egg-yolk pasta — refined, warm, and deeply satisfying.

LISTEN ON SPOTIFY

Wednesday, March 11

AM | ✈️ LAURA DEPARTS FOR PORTLAND
4:00–7:00 | 📺 YAT TECH WEEK (DAN PICKUP)

Laura's flight lifts off this morning, and the house reshapes itself around two instead of three. Light drizzle outside mirrors the transition — but inside, Masego's playful saxophone keeps things upbeat. Dan picks Elsie up from rehearsal for the first time solo, and the one-pan chicken couscous is designed for exactly this moment: minimal effort, maximum comfort, three easy elevations that take under three minutes total. Tonight is about finding the rhythm of just-the-two-of-us.

One-Pan Chicken Broccoli Couscous

MEDITERRANEAN

Chicken cooked with broccoli and couscous in one pan with chicken broth, lemon, and garlic — a weeknight workhorse

chicken thighs, broccoli, couscous, chicken broth, lemon

AT THE TABLE

It's just you and me tonight, roommate. If we weren't parent and kid — if we were just two people sharing this apartment for the week — what three house rules would you want us to have?

The first solo-Dad dinner needs to feel special, not sad. This question reframes the dynamic playfully — 'roommates' gives Elsie a sense of partnership and autonomy rather than absence. Eight-year-olds are building their sense of fairness and self-governance; letting her set 'rules' gives her agency during a week when things feel different.

The Trust You Build Before You Need It

Brené Brown tells a story in **Daring Greatly** about a marble jar. Her daughter's teacher kept a jar in the classroom, and every time the class made a good collective decision, a marble went in. When the jar was full, they earned a party. But here's the insight Brown extracts: trust works the same way. It's not built in grand gestures — the big anniversary trip, the dramatic apology, the once-a-year heart-to-heart. It's built in tiny, repeated moments of follow-through. Showing up on time. Remembering the thing the other person mentioned last Tuesday. Doing what you said you'd do, even when nobody's checking. "Trust is built in very small moments," Brown writes, citing John Gottman's research on relationships (**Daring Greatly**, Ch. 2). Preparation, it turns out, is one of the most powerful trust-building activities in a relationship, precisely because it's invisible. When Laura packs for Portland and leaves behind a labeled schedule on the fridge, containers of prepped lunches, and a note for Elsie's teacher about pickup — that's not just logistics. That's marbles in the jar. It says: I thought about you when you weren't in front of me.

The flip side is equally important. When Dan prepares for the solo-parenting stretch — not by being told what to do, but by proactively planning meals, confirming carpool times, and knowing which costume pieces Elsie needs for which rehearsal — that's also marbles in the jar. It tells Laura she can focus on her work in Portland without carrying the cognitive load of home in her back pocket. And when Elsie runs her lines one more time before bed, even though she's tired and the couch is right there, she's putting marbles in her own jar — building trust with herself that she can handle Saturday's stage. Brown's research consistently shows that the people who feel most connected aren't the ones with the most dramatic love stories. They're the ones who've accumulated the most small moments of reliability. Preparation is reliability made visible. This week, every act of getting-ready is simultaneously an act of care for someone else, a marble dropped quietly into a jar that nobody's counting but everybody feels. Who are you preparing for — and do they know it?

"Trust is built in very small moments."

— Brené Brown, *Daring Greatly* Ch. 2

Reflect: Who are you preparing for this week — and do they know it?

HUNGRY HAPPENS · 4 SERVINGS · PREP 15 MIN · COOK 25 MIN

MAMMA KAREN SAYS

Season those chicken thighs with salt, garlic powder, onion powder. Skin side down in hot olive oil, don't move them for six minutes. You want golden, not pale. Flip, four more minutes, then out. Same pan, butter and lemon slices go in, sear them quick. Shallots, broccoli, couscous, toast it all two minutes. Garlic, wine, broth, Italian herbs, everything in. Chicken goes back on top, nestled in nice. Lid on, simmer twelve minutes. Dan, this is a Wednesday night dinner that looks like you tried. And you barely had to.

HOW IT COMES TOGETHER

A · SEASON CHICKEN, SEAR SKIN-DOWN 6 MIN, FLIP 4 MIN, SET ASIDE

- 4 bone-in skin-on chicken thighs (*patted dry*)
- to taste salt, garlic powder, onion powder
- 2 Tbs olive oil (*divided*)

B · SEAR LEMON SLICES BOTH SIDES, SAUTE SHALLOT 2 MIN

- 1 Tbs butter
- 1 small lemon (*thin sliced, seeds removed*)
- 1 large shallot (*sliced*)

C · ADD BROCCOLI AND COUSCOUS, TOAST 2 MIN, GARLIC 30 SEC, WINE 1 MIN, THEN BROTH AND HERBS

- 4 cups broccoli (*small florets*)
- 1.25 cups pearl couscous
- 4 cloves garlic (*minced*)
- 1/2 cup dry white wine
- 2 cups low-sodium chicken broth
- 1 tsp Italian herb blend

Final: return lemon slices and chicken to pan → bring to boil, lid on, simmer 12-14 min → uncover, cook 2 more min → garnish with fresh parsley

VARIATIONS

Mediterranean Chicken Couscous with Pistachio Gremolata — Add bell peppers, olives, and smoked paprika, finish with a pistachio-parsley-1... (recipe)

Greek Lemon Chicken with Pearl Couscous and Feta — Swap broccoli for spinach, add oregano and crumbled feta, finish with lemon zest (recipe)

Harissa Chicken Couscous — Marinate chicken in harissa paste and citrus, add carrots and serve with yogurt... (recipe)

CHEF'S TIPS

PREPARATION Toast the Couscous First — Dry-toast the couscous in the pan before adding broth — this single 90-second step transforms bland grains into something with backbone. After removing chicken, scatter dry couscous in hot pan. Stir ...

ACID The Lemon Squeeze — A generous squeeze of fresh lemon over the finished dish right before serving — the simplest and most impactful upgrade. Squeeze half a lemon over the plated dish. Give Elsie the other half to squeez...

SAUCE Cold Butter Finish — A pat of cold butter stirred into the hot couscous right off the heat creates an effortless glossy richness. Off heat, drop 1 tbsp cold butter onto couscous. Stir gently until melted and glossy.

M A S E G O

Masego

2 0 2 3 . .

The self-proclaimed inventor of TrapHouseJazz delivers his most complete album yet — a genre-bending romp through jazz,...

First solo dinner with Dad — needs upbeat, fun energy. Masego's playful saxophone and humor will keep the mood light and Elsie laughing.

LISTEN ON SPOTIFY

Thursday, March 12

4:00–7:00 | 🍷 YAT TECH WEEK (DAN PICKUP)

Mid-week solo parenting, and the rhythm is settling in. Drizzle and wind outside, but inside it's taco night — the easiest, most reliable dinner in the rotation. Sunday's pickled red onions are still perfect in the fridge, ready to crown each taco with pink, crunchy tang. Black Pumas' vintage psychedelic soul fills the kitchen with warm Austin vibes. No extra ingredients needed tonight. Just bloom the seasoning, char the tortillas, and let Elsie build her own.

American Tacos with Costco Taco Seasoning

TEX - MEX

Classic ground beef tacos with Costco taco seasoning and standard toppings — a reliable crowd-pleaser

ground beef, Costco taco seasoning, taco shells, onion, toppings

AT THE TABLE

In your play, you get to become someone else on stage. If you could step into the life of anyone you actually know — a friend, a teacher, someone at YAT — for just one day, who would you pick and what do you think you'd learn?

Perspective-taking is a critical skill at age 8, when empathy is developing rapidly but still needs scaffolding. Connecting it to her theatrical experience makes it concrete — she already knows what it feels like to 'be' someone else. This question extends that skill into real life.

The Pre-Mortem

Daniel Kahneman, the Nobel-winning psychologist behind **Thinking, Fast and Slow**, popularized a devastatingly simple technique for improving decisions: the pre-mortem. Here's how it works. Before you launch a project, a plan, or a week, you imagine it has already failed. Completely. Then you ask: why? What went wrong? The beauty of this exercise — originally developed by psychologist Gary Klein — is that it gives people permission to voice concerns they'd otherwise suppress out of optimism or group loyalty. "The pre-mortem is a great technique for identifying threats to a plan," Kahneman has noted in discussing Klein's work. It works because it doesn't ask **whether** something might go wrong — it assumes something already did, and your only job is to tell the story of the failure. Try it with this week. It's Saturday morning. The week went sideways. What happened? Maybe Dan forgot to confirm Wednesday's carpool and spent a frantic half-hour rearranging rides. Maybe Elsie's costume piece got left at school Tuesday and nobody noticed until Thursday's dress rehearsal. Maybe nobody planned dinner for the night Laura flew out, and the transition from two parents to one was rocky instead of smooth.

The pre-mortem doesn't create anxiety — it relieves it, because unnamed fears are always worse than named ones. Once you've identified the three or four most likely failure points, you can build simple safeguards. A text reminder on your phone. A packed bag sitting by the door Tuesday night. A frozen meal earmarked for Wednesday so nobody has to think about dinner during the transition. Klein's research found that pre-mortems increased the ability to correctly identify reasons for future failure by roughly 30 percent (**Sources of Power**, Ch. 4). That's not a small edge — it's the difference between a week that hums along and one that lurches from one small crisis to the next. The key is doing this exercise now, while you still have time to adjust, not Friday morning when the dominoes are already tipping. Preparation isn't about controlling every outcome. It's about creating margins wide enough that when the unexpected happens — and it always does — you can absorb it without breaking stride. What are the two most likely ways this week falls apart, and what's one simple safeguard you could set up for each before tonight?

"The pre-mortem is a great technique for identifying threats to a plan."

— Daniel Kahneman, discussing Gary Klein's work

Reflect: What are the two most likely ways this week could go sideways, and what's one simple thing you could do about each right now?

ONCE UPON A CHEF · 4-6 (ABOUT 12 TACOS) SERVINGS · PREP 10 MIN · COOK 15 MIN

MAMMA KAREN SAYS

Brown the beef in a hot pan. Break it up good, no big chunks. Drain the fat if there's too much, but leave a little for flavor. Sprinkle the Costco taco seasoning packet over the meat, pour in a splash of water, and let it simmer until the sauce gets thick and coats everything. That's it. Warm your shells. Set out the toppings. Lettuce, tomato, cheese, sour cream. Let Elsie build her own. She'll eat twice as much when she gets to pick what goes in it. See? Taco Thursday is the easiest night of the week.

HOW IT COMES TOGETHER

A · BROWN BEEF AND ONION 5-7 MIN, DRAIN EXCESS FAT, ADD SEASONING AND WATER, SIMMER 3-5 MIN

- 1 Tbs olive oil
- 1 lb ground beef (80/20)
- 1/2 onion (*finely diced (optional)*)
- 1 packet Kirkland (Costco) taco seasoning
- 1/2 cup water

B · WARM IN OVEN AT 325F FOR 3 MIN

- 12 crunchy taco shells or flour tortillas (*warmed*)

C · SET OUT IN BOWLS FOR TACO BAR

- 1 cup shredded cheddar cheese
- 2 cups shredded lettuce
- 2 tomatoes (*diced*)
- 1/2 cup sour cream
- 1/2 cup salsa
- 1 avocado (*sliced (optional)*)

Final: spoon meat into warmed shells → let everyone top their own → serve with extra salsa and lime wedges

VARIATIONS

Korean Beef Tacos — Season ground beef with soy sauce, sesame oil, gochujang, and brown sugar, top ...
(recipe)

Smash Burger Tacos — Press seasoned beef balls onto a hot skillet directly on flour tortillas for cr... (recipe)

Black Bean and Corn Tacos — Skip the beef entirely, use seasoned black beans and charred corn for a quick
v... (recipe)

CHEF'S TIPS

PREPARATION Bloom the Seasoning in the Fat — Cook the seasoning dry in the rendered beef fat for 60 seconds before adding water — this doubles the flavor of the same packet. Drain beef leaving 1 tbsp fat. Sprinkle seasoning on meat, stir 60 sec...

ACID Sunday's Pickled Red Onions — The pickled red onions from Sunday are still perfect in the fridge — the single best taco topping that exists. Use Sunday's leftover pickled onions. If gone: thin-slice 1/2 red onion, cover with ACV ...

PREPARATION Char the Tortillas Properly — A properly charred tortilla is the difference between a taco and a sad wrap — 20 seconds per side in a screaming hot dry skillet. Screaming hot dry skillet. Each tortilla 20 seconds per side until ch...

BLACK PUMAS

Black Pumas

2019 · ·

Austin psychedelic soul duo whose self-titled debut earned a Grammy nomination. Eric Burton's raw, passionate vocals ov...

Classic American tacos meet classic American soul. Black Pumas' vintage warmth and underdog story pair naturally with the casual, comfort-food energy of taco night.

LISTEN ON SPOTIFY

Friday, March 13

4:00–7:00 | 🗣️ YAT TECH WEEK — FINAL REHEARSAL (DAN PICKUP)

The night before the big show. Elsie comes home from her last rehearsal buzzing with a cocktail of excitement and nerves, and Dan meets her with the ultimate comfort food: mac and cheese with charred broccoli and a buttered panko crunch top. Tank and the Bangas' joyful, eclectic energy matches the pre-show electricity perfectly. Tomorrow Laura comes home, and Elsie takes the stage. Tonight, it's just Dad, his girl, and a bowl of the good stuff.

Mac & Cheese with Broccoli

AMERICAN COMFORT

One-pot mac and cheese with cheddar and broccoli — the ultimate Friday comfort food for a tired dad and a tired kid

elbow macaroni, broccoli, butter, milk, cheddar, Dijon

AT THE TABLE

You picked tonight's dinner — chef's choice, mac and cheese. If you were in charge of planning our whole weekend, not just dinner but everything from wake-up to bedtime, what would the Dan-and-Elsie Saturday look like before the big show?

This is the last quiet evening before the performance. Letting Elsie plan Saturday morning gives her ownership and control during a week that's felt big and fast. It also opens a natural door to talk about pre-show feelings without asking directly. Eight-year-olds thrive when they feel trusted to lead.

The Case Against Over-Preparation

Naval Ravikant would push back on everything you've read this week, and he'd have a point. Naval distinguishes between two kinds of work: execution work, where preparation is king, and creative work, where preparation can become a cage. Over-prepare for a creative task and you kill the very spontaneity that makes it valuable. Over-schedule a week with a child and you squeeze out the unstructured time where the best conversations happen — the walk home that turns into a twenty-minute discussion about whether animals dream, the bedtime that stretches because she wants to tell you about something weird that happened at lunch. "Free time is the most expensive time you have," Naval has said, "because it's the only time you can think clearly." The implication is sharp: if every minute of Dan's solo-parenting week is scheduled and optimized, he might execute flawlessly and still miss the whole point. Jane Austen captured this centuries earlier in *Emma*: "Why not seize the pleasure at once? How often is happiness destroyed by preparation, foolish preparation!"

So where's the line? Nassim Taleb offers a useful framework in *Antifragile*, Ch. 3, with his concept of optionality: build structures that let good surprises find you. The best-prepared week isn't the one with the tightest schedule — it's the one with the sturdiest floor and the most open ceiling. Prepare the skeleton, not the flesh. Know what's for dinner, but don't script the conversation. Have the costume ready, but let Elsie decide when to practice her lines versus when to just be a kid watching cartoons in her pajamas. The contrarian view isn't that preparation is wrong — this whole week's theme still holds. The contrarian view is that preparation is a means, not an end, and the moment it starts consuming more energy than it saves, you've crossed a line from discipline into rigidity. The master chef preps every ingredient before service begins — that's preparation. But the meal itself is improvised, responsive, alive. What separates a great week from a merely efficient one is knowing when to follow the plan and when to throw it away. Where this week have you over-prepared, and what space did that crowd out?

"Why not seize the pleasure at once? How often is happiness destroyed by preparation, foolish preparation!"

— Jane Austen, *Emma*

Reflect: Where this week have you over-prepared — and what spontaneous moment did that crowd out?

FEEL GOOD FOODIE · 4 SERVINGS · PREP 10 MIN · COOK 20 MIN

MAMMA KAREN SAYS

Boil your pasta in good salty water. Steam the broccoli right on top in a colander. In another pot, melt the butter, whisk in the flour, let it go golden two minutes. Now the milk goes in, warm milk if you're smart, and whisk until it thickens. Dijon mustard, just a little. Then the cheese, cheddar and gruyere, low heat, stir it in handful by handful. Fold in the pasta and broccoli. Eat it now while it's hot and perfect. If you want to get fancy, put some breadcrumbs on top and run it under the broiler. But it's Friday night, honey, you've done enough this week.

HOW IT COMES TOGETHER

A · BOIL PASTA AL DENTE, STEAM BROCCOLI ON TOP 1-2 MIN, DRAIN PASTA, BLANCH BROCCOLI

- 8 oz elbow macaroni
- 3 cups broccoli florets

B · MELT BUTTER, WHISK IN FLOUR 2 MIN, ADD WARM MILK, SIMMER AND WHISK 5-7 MIN UNTIL THICK

- 2 Tbs salted butter
- 2 Tbs all-purpose flour
- 2 cups 2% milk (*warmed*)
- 1 tsp Dijon mustard
- to taste salt and pepper

C · STIR INTO SAUCE OFF HEAT UNTIL MELTED AND SMOOTH

- 1 cup cheddar cheese (*shredded from block*)
- 1 cup gruyere cheese (*shredded from block*)

Final: add Dijon mustard to sauce → fold in cooked pasta and broccoli → serve immediately

VARIATIONS

Buffalo Chicken Broccoli Mac — Add shredded rotisserie chicken tossed in buffalo sauce, swap some cheddar for ... (recipe)

Butternut Squash Mac and Cheese — Blend roasted butternut squash into the cheese sauce for hidden veggies, extra ... (recipe)

Baked Mac and Cheese with Crispy Panko Top — Transfer to a baking dish, top with panko breadcrumbs and extra Parmesan, bake ... (recipe)

CHEF'S TIPS

SAUCE The Dijon Mustard Secret — One teaspoon of Dijon mustard stirred into the cheese sauce — invisible to kids, transformative to flavor. Stir 1 tsp Dijon mustard into the cheese sauce as you add the cheese. Stir until incorporated.

TEXTURE Buttered Panko Crunch Top — Golden, butter-toasted panko breadcrumbs scattered on top of each bowl — the thing that separates restaurant mac from homemade mac. Melt 1 tbsp butter, add 1/4 cup panko, stir 2 min until golden. Sca...

PREPARATION Broiler-Charred Broccoli — Char the broccoli under the broiler instead of steaming it in the pot — nutty, sweet, slightly smoky instead of soggy and green. Toss broccoli with 1 tsp olive oil + pinch of salt on sheet pan. Broil...

TANK AND THE BANGAS

Green Balloon

2019 · ·

New Orleans collective whose NPR Tiny Desk Contest win launched them into the spotlight. Tarriona Tank Ball is a force ...

Dad-daughter comfort food night calls for Tank's exuberant, genre-hopping joy.

The album's energy matches Elsie's pre-show excitement — it's the night before the

big performance!

LISTEN ON SPOTIFY

Saturday, March 14

PM	✈️ LAURA RETURNS FROM PORTLAND
4:00–7:00	🎭 ELSIE'S YAT PLAY — SHOWTIME! 🌟
EVENING	🍕 PIZZA CELEBRATION DINNER

The big day. Laura returns from Portland just in time. The family reunites in a darkened auditorium to watch Elsie step into the spotlight and do the brave thing she’s been preparing for all week. After the curtain call, it’s pizza on real plates with a candle on the table, sparkling water in wine glasses, and Ezra Collective’s Mercury Prize-winning Afrobeat-jazz filling the room with pure celebration. The week’s theme comes full circle: every star has a stage crew, and tonight, the whole crew is together.

Pizza after Elsie’s YAT Play

ITALIAN-AMERICAN

Ordered pizza after Elsie's theater performance — a celebration meal where the experience matters more than the food

cheese pizza, specialty pizza, side salad

AT THE TABLE

You just performed! Forget whether it went 'well' or 'badly' — tell me about one single moment on stage tonight. What were you feeling right then, in your body and in your head?

After a performance, kids (and adults) tend to evaluate: was I good? This question sidesteps judgment and asks Elsie to notice her own experience. It builds emotional granularity — the ability to name specific feelings beyond 'good' or 'nervous.' Savoring a moment of courage, even a scary one, teaches her that bravery is something she can feel in her body.

Curtain Call

Jocko Willink, the retired Navy SEAL commander who co-wrote **Extreme Ownership**, has a phrase that sounds almost comically simple: "Discipline equals freedom." It's become a bumper sticker, a podcast title, a tattoo — but the depth underneath it is real, and it maps perfectly onto this week. What Willink means is that the person who has prepared — who has done the boring, repetitive, unglamorous work of getting ready — is the one who has the most freedom when the moment arrives. The unprepared person is reactive, scrambling, making decisions under pressure with incomplete information. The prepared person has already made those decisions, calmly, with time to think, and now they're free to be fully present. "The more you practice, the more you drill, the more you prepare," Willink writes (**Extreme Ownership**, Ch. 2), the more freedom you have to adapt when things inevitably go sideways. Today is Elsie's performance. The lights go up, the audience settles, and whatever preparation has happened — the tech rehearsals, the line-running, the costume fittings, the long drives back and forth — either holds or it doesn't.

But here's what Willink would tell her: the preparation already worked. Not because it guaranteed perfection — nothing does — but because it built the confidence to recover from imperfection. A missed cue isn't a catastrophe when you've rehearsed enough to find your way back. A stumbled line isn't a disaster when your body knows the blocking well enough to keep moving. This is the thread that connects the entire week. Laura prepared for Portland so she could focus once she arrived — discipline creating the freedom to be fully present in her work. Dan prepared for solo parenting so the days could breathe instead of suffocate — discipline creating the freedom to actually enjoy his daughter rather than just manage her schedule. Robert Greene, in **Mastery**, calls the endpoint of deep preparation "Alive Time" — the state where conscious effort quiets and something deeper takes over. It looks like talent to the audience. It looks like natural ease to the casual observer. But everyone backstage knows the truth: it's hundreds of small, unglamorous decisions, stacked invisibly, made weightless by the discipline that preceded them. The curtain goes up tonight. And preparation becomes performance.

"Discipline equals freedom."

— Jocko Willink, *Extreme Ownership*

Reflect: What did you prepare this week that's ready to become something more?

The curtain rises, the plane departs, the week unfolds — and everything that looks effortless was built in the hours nobody saw.

MAMMA KAREN SAYS

Tonight we celebrate. Elsie was on that stage and she was magnificent, and nobody is cooking. You call the pizza place. Get one cheese for the little one because she earned it. Get one with something good for the grown-ups, pepperoni, sausage, whatever makes you happy. When it arrives, put it on real plates. Light a candle. Pour the drinks. Just because it came in a box doesn't mean it can't feel special. And save a slice for tomorrow because cold pizza for breakfast is a reward for a good week.

HOW IT COMES TOGETHER

A · ORDER FROM FAVORITE LOCAL SPOT 30 MIN BEFORE SHOWTIME ENDS

- 1 large cheese pizza (*for Elsie*)
- 1 specialty pizza (pepperoni, sausage, or veggie) (*for Dan and Laura*)

B · TOSS SALAD WHILE PIZZA IS EN ROUTE

- 1 bag pre-made side salad (*optional but recommended*)
- 1 bottle Italian dressing or ranch

C · SET A PROPER TABLE BECAUSE TONIGHT MATTERS

- 1 candle (*for the table*)
- 3 real plates (not paper)
- 1 beverage of choice (*sparkling water, juice, or wine*)

Final: open the boxes with ceremony → serve on real plates with salad → toast Elsie's performance → save leftovers for Saturday morning cold pizza breakfast

VARIATIONS

Homemade Flatbread Pizza — Use store-bought naan or pita as a quick base, let everyone top their own mini ... (recipe)

Pizza Quesadillas — Spread pizza sauce and mozzarella inside flour tortillas, cook in a skillet for... (recipe)

French Bread Pizza — Split a baguette, load with sauce and cheese, broil until bubbly for the fastest... (recipe)

CHEF'S TIPS

SAUCE DIY Dipping Sauce Station — Three ramekins of dipping sauces turn ordered pizza from delivery food into an event — and let Elsie feel like she's at a restaurant.

Three ramekins: ranch (from fridge), garlic butter (2 tbsp butter...

TEMPERATURE Cold Parm Salad on the Side — A simple cold salad next to hot pizza — a restaurant move that takes 3 minutes and makes both taste better. Toss greens with 1 tbsp olive oil, juice of 1/2 lemon, pinch of salt. Shave Parmesan on top...

PREPARATION The Celebration Table — Set the table like it matters — because after a week of play rehearsal and solo parenting, it does. Real plates, cloth napkins, candle. Sparkling water in wine glasses. Handwritten 'playbill' card at...

EZRA COLLECTIVE

Where I'm Meant to Be

2022 · ·

Mercury Prize-winning London jazz collective blending Afrobeat,
Caribbean rhythms, and jazz improvisation into somethin...

*Elsie just performed! Laura's back! This calls for the most joyful, celebratory album
in the list. Ezra Collective's title says it all — tonight, everyone is exactly where
they're meant to be.*

LISTEN ON SPOTIFY

Kitchen & Pantry

Appetizers, salads, and beverages

Appetizers

Baba Ganoush with Warm Pita

Smoky, creamy eggplant dip with tahini, garlic, lemon.

eggplant, tahini, garlic, lemon juice, Greek yogurt, olive oil, pine nuts

Salads

COMPOSED DINNER

Mediterranean Chickpea Salad with Lemon-Herb Dressing

An artfully arranged platter of tender chickpeas, halved.

Dressing: Bright lemon vinaigrette: 3 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil, 2 tbsp fresh lemon.

TOSSED DINNER

Thai Chicken Salad with Chilli Lime Dressing

A generously portioned tossed salad with poached and.

Dressing: Thai chilli lime dressing: 2 tbsp lime juice, 1 tbsp fish sauce, 1 tbsp chilli.

SIDE

Broccoli Salad with Smoky Tamari Almonds

Crisp raw broccoli florets and diced stems tossed in a.

Dressing: Tangy mustard dressing: 2 tbsp mayonnaise, 2 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil, 2.

SIDE

Fattoush Salad with Sumac-Lemon Vinaigrette

A vibrant Lebanese bread salad with crispy toasted pita.

Dressing: Sumac-lemon vinaigrette: 3 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil, 2 tbsp fresh lemon.

Beverage Pairings

New Zealand Sauvignon Blanc (Marlborough)

A crisp, aromatic white wine with.

The high acid cuts through rich, buttery salmon glaze and stands up to Cajun spice. Look for Cloudy Bay, Kim Crawford, or Oyster Bay — widely available at \$12-18.

Belgian-Style Witbier (Blue Moon or Allagash White)

A hazy, refreshing wheat beer brewed.

The coriander and citrus in the beer echo the warm spices in shawarma and falafel. A crowd-pleasing, easy-drinking beer for a warm spring evening.

Sparkling Mint Lemonade (Limonana)

A refreshing Middle Eastern iced.

Elsie-approved! A fun, fancy-feeling drink for the whole family. Especially refreshing with the warm 70°F+ weekend forecast. Make a big pitcher for Saturday's celebration dinner.

Family Corner

Conversation starters, parenting nudges, and connection ideas

Parenting Corner

Every Star Has a Stage Crew

This week, everyone in the family is stepping into an unfamiliar role. Elsie is performing under the lights, Dan is running the household solo, and Laura is trusting her team from Portland. Just like in theater, every role matters — the star on stage, the director backstage, the producer who believes from far away. Look for moments to notice the invisible work that makes things run, and remind Elsie (and yourself) that courage isn't just about the spotlight. It's about showing up, every day, even when nobody's watching.

Dinner Conversation Starters

SUNDAY, MARCH 8 — PULLED PORK PICNIC WITH COLE SLAW ON TACO SHELLS

"This pulled pork has been cooking low and slow all day, just quietly getting ready. What's something YOU've been working on slowly that you're almost ready to show people?"

Connects the slow-cooking metaphor to Elsie's own preparation for Saturday's performance. Lets her name what she's been building toward, which strengthens her sense of competence and anticipation. At 8, kids are learning to recognize their own growth — this question holds up a mirror.

MONDAY, MARCH 9 — CHICKPEA & BROCCOLI CURRY OVER RICE

"Tech week started today! What's one thing your director or a crew member did that most people in the audience will never know about?"

Draws attention to behind-the-scenes contributions — the stagehands, the costume helper, the kid who moves the props. This builds gratitude and connects directly to the weekly story about the school janitor. At 8, kids are developing moral reasoning about fairness and recognition; noticing invisible labor is a powerful lesson.

TUESDAY, MARCH 10 — BABO PASTA WITH ALFREDO SAUCE

"This is our last dinner all three of us before Mom flies to Portland. If you could give Mom one thing to carry in her suitcase that would remind her of us — not clothes, something more like a feeling or a memory — what would you pack for her?"

Tuesday is the emotional pivot of the week — the last full-family dinner before Laura leaves. This question lets Elsie process the upcoming separation through imagination rather than anxiety. Naming a feeling or memory she'd 'pack' builds emotional vocabulary and gives the family a sweet shared moment before the shift.

WEDNESDAY, MARCH 11 — ONE-PAN CHICKEN BROCCOLI COUSCOUS

"It's just you and me tonight, roommate. If we weren't parent and kid — if we were just two people sharing this apartment for the week — what three house rules would you want us to have?"

The first solo-Dad dinner needs to feel special, not sad. This question reframes the dynamic playfully — 'roommates' gives Elsie a sense of partnership and autonomy rather than absence. Eight-year-olds are building their sense of fairness and self-governance; letting her set 'rules' gives her agency during a week when things feel different.

Conversation Starters (continued)

THURSDAY, MARCH 12 — AMERICAN TACOS WITH COSTCO TACO SEASONING

"In your play, you get to become someone else on stage. If you could step into the life of anyone you actually know — a friend, a teacher, someone at YAT — for just one day, who would you pick and what do you think you'd learn?"

Perspective-taking is a critical skill at age 8, when empathy is developing rapidly but still needs scaffolding.

Connecting it to her theatrical experience makes it concrete — she already knows what it feels like to 'be' someone else. This question extends that skill into real life.

FRIDAY, MARCH 13 — MAC & CHEESE WITH BROCCOLI

"You picked tonight's dinner — chef's choice, mac and cheese. If you were in charge of planning our whole weekend, not just dinner but everything from wake-up to bedtime, what would the Dan-and-Elsie Saturday look like before the big show?"

This is the last quiet evening before the performance. Letting Elsie plan Saturday morning gives her ownership and control during a week that's felt big and fast. It also opens a natural door to talk about pre-show feelings without asking directly. Eight-year-olds thrive when they feel trusted to lead.

SATURDAY, MARCH 14 — PIZZA AFTER ELSIE'S YAT PLAY

"You just performed! Forget whether it went 'well' or 'badly' — tell me about one single moment on stage tonight. What were you feeling right then, in your body and in your head?"

After a performance, kids (and adults) tend to evaluate: was I good? This question sidesteps judgment and asks Elsie to notice her own experience. It builds emotional granularity — the ability to name specific feelings beyond 'good' or 'nervous.' Savoring a moment of courage, even a scary one, teaches her that bravery is something she can feel in her body.

Nudges

The Pep-Talk Jar

Elsie has tech rehearsals every evening this week, building toward Saturday's performance. The nerves will build alongside the excitement.

Starting Sunday night, grab a mason jar (or a bowl, a shoe — anything with an opening) and write one short note of encouragement each evening. Just a sentence or two on a scrap of paper: 'I watched you practice your lines in the mirror and I thought — she's got this.' Dan writes his in person. Laura texts or voice-memos hers from Portland and Dan transcribes them. On Saturday morning, before the show, Elsie opens them all at once.

1. Find a jar or container Sunday evening and label it 'Open Saturday Morning'
 2. Each night after Elsie goes to bed, write a short, specific note about something you noticed that day — not generic praise, but something real you saw
 3. Text Laura each evening to send her contribution — she writes from Portland, you fold it in
 4. Saturday morning, let Elsie open them all at breakfast. Don't rush it. Let her read each one.
-

The Wednesday Night Reset

Wednesday is the first evening without Laura, and Elsie will come home from a 3-hour rehearsal tired and possibly emotional. The temptation will be to fill the gap with chatter or distraction.

After you pick Elsie up from rehearsal, don't ask questions in the car. Put on her favorite music and let her decompress. When you get home, do something intentionally low-key together before dinner: sit on the porch in the warm spring air (it'll be 66°F), make hot chocolate, or lie on the floor and listen to one song with your eyes closed. Five minutes of shared stillness says 'this is okay, we've got this' louder than any pep talk.

1. Have her favorite playlist queued up in the car before pickup
 2. When she gets in, just say 'Hey, kid' — no questions about rehearsal yet
 3. At home, offer one simple choice: 'Porch, hot chocolate, or floor music?' — let her pick
 4. Set a mental timer for 5 minutes of no agenda. If she talks, listen. If she doesn't, that's fine too.
-

The Post-Show Download

Saturday night, after the performance, Dan and Laura will both be buzzing with pride. The instinct will be to shower Elsie with praise and analysis. Resist it — at least for the first few minutes.

After the show, give Elsie a huge hug. Then, instead of 'You were amazing!' (which evaluates), try: 'I'm so glad I got to watch you do that. What do you want to tell me?' Let her lead. She might want to talk about the one line she almost forgot, or the funny thing that happened backstage, or she might just want pizza. Her experience of the performance matters more than your review of it.

1. Agree with Laura beforehand: first response is a hug and 'What do you want to tell me?'
 2. Let Elsie steer the conversation at the pizza celebration — if she wants to replay every moment, great. If she wants to talk about something else entirely, follow her lead
 3. Later that night, at bedtime, try: 'What's something about tonight you want to remember when you're older?'
-

Reflection

Stage Fright on a Summer Night by Mary Pope Osborne

In this Magic Tree House adventure (#25), Jack and Annie travel back to Elizabethan London and end up performing on stage at the Globe Theatre — terrified, unprepared, and thrilling. It's a quick chapter-book read (perfect for bedtime this week) that normalizes stage fright, celebrates improvisation, and shows that the best performances come from heart, not perfection. Elsie will see herself in Annie's mix of fear and determination.

Directly mirrors Elsie's week — tech rehearsals, mounting nerves, and the thrill of stepping on stage. Reading it Monday-Wednesday gives her a fictional companion going through the same journey. Plus, it's genuinely fun, which matters when the week is already intense.

The Director's Chair: This week, you're not just Dad — you're the chauffeur, the lunch-packer, the audience of one at the dinner table, and the calm backstage presence Elsie needs before Saturday's curtain call. That's a lot of roles for one person. Here's the thing, though: you don't have to perform any of them perfectly. What Elsie will remember about this week isn't whether the couscous was slightly overcooked on Wednesday or whether you forgot to sign something for school. She'll remember that you were there — at every rehearsal pickup, at every dinner, in every quiet moment between the chaos. Solo parenting can feel lonely, especially at 8 PM when the house is quiet and there's no other adult to debrief with. Give yourself permission to feel that. Text Laura. Call a friend. Or just sit with the stillness and recognize that you're doing something deeply meaningful: showing your daughter that when Mom travels, the family doesn't just survive — it hums along with warmth and intention. She's watching how you handle this week, and what she sees will quietly shape how she imagines partnership, resilience, and love for the rest of her life. And Saturday, when she steps on that stage and the lights come up — look at her face. Really look. That's the face of a girl who knows, bone-deep, that she is loved. You helped build that. Not just this week, but every week that came before it.

You don't need to be a perfect parent — just a present one.

The Stoic Guide

VIRTUE

Stepping Into the Role

When life hands you a part you didn't rehearse — solo parent, performer, traveler — the Stoics say: play it admirably. This week, every member of the family steps into a role that asks more of them than usual. The virtue is not in choosing the role, but in how fully you inhabit it.

"Remember that you are an actor in a play, the character of which is determined by the Playwright: if He wishes the play to be short, it is short; if long, it is long; if He wishes you to play the part of a beggar, remember to act even this rôle adroitly; and so if your rôle be that of a cripple, an official, or a layman. For this is your business, to play admirably the rôle assigned you; but the selection of that rôle is Another's."

— Epictetus, *Enchiridion* 17

This week, each member of your family steps into a role they didn't audition for. Laura boards a plane for Portland on Wednesday, carrying the weight of work that calls her away from home. Dan becomes the solo parent — cook, comforter, chauffeur, and cheerleader — for four days. And Elsie walks into tech week for her play, where every rehearsal sharpens the performance that Saturday's audience will see. None of you chose these roles in a vacuum. Life assigned them. The question the Stoics pose is not whether you wanted the part, but whether you will play it well. Epictetus, the former slave who became one of philosophy's greatest teachers, built his entire ethics around this theatrical metaphor. You are an actor in a play whose script you did not write. You cannot control the plot — the business trip, the solo nights, the stage fright. But you can control your performance. You can bring your full attention, your full courage, your full love to the role you've been given.

SUNDAY Know Your Part

Before an actor steps on stage, she reads the script. She doesn't argue with the playwright about why her character has these lines and not others — she learns them. Epictetus taught that the first task of philosophy is self-knowledge: 'First say to yourself what you would be; and then do what you have to do.' Today, look at the week ahead and name your roles honestly. Dan: you will be both parents for half this week. Laura: you will carry work that matters in a city far from home.

Write down the roles you will play this week. For each one, name the single quality it asks of you most (patience? courage? focus?).

"First say to yourself what you would be; and then do what you have to do." — Epictetus, Discourses III.23.1

MONDAY The Rehearsal Is the Work

We tend to think of preparation as the thing before the real thing. But the Stoics saw it differently. Seneca wrote that the man who has anticipated troubles takes away their power when they arrive. Every rehearsal Elsie runs this week is not filler before Saturday — it is Saturday, in miniature. Every meal Dan plans before Wednesday is not logistics — it is love made practical. Preparation is not waiting. It is the first act of courage.

What is one thing you can prepare for today that will make a harder day this week easier? Do that thing.

"The man who has anticipated the coming of troubles takes away their power when they arrive." — Seneca, Letters to Lucilius

Reflections & Practice

TUESDAY The Eve of Separation

Tomorrow, your household splits into two smaller ones — Laura in Portland, Dan and Elsie here. The Stoics did not pretend that separation was painless. Marcus Aurelius missed his family during long campaigns on the frontier. But he also knew that missing someone is a testament to love, not a weakness to suppress. Tonight, be fully present with each other. Not because tomorrow is sad, but because tonight is real. Epictetus compared life to a voyage — sometimes the captain calls, and you must go.

At dinner tonight, tell each person at the table one specific thing you admire about them. No qualifiers, no jokes — just the truth.

"Accept the things to which fate binds you, and love the people with whom fate brings you together, but do so with all your heart." — Marcus Aurelius, Meditations VI.39

WEDNESDAY Stepping Into the Breach

Laura's flight lifts off in the early dark. Dan, the house is yours now. Epictetus would say: this is not a burden — it is your stage. The Stoics believed that difficulties reveal character. 'It is difficulties that show what men are,' Epictetus wrote in the Discourses. Solo parenting is not a diminished version of parenting — it is parenting with the volume turned up. Every decision is yours. Every bedtime story, every packed lunch, every reassurance when Elsie is nervous about the play. You don't need to be perfect. You need to be present.

Dan: What is one thing you can do tonight that is distinctly yours — your way of tucking in, your choice of bedtime story, your own rhythm? Lean into it. Laura: Write Elsie a short note she can find tomorrow.

"It is difficulties that show what men are." — Epictetus, Discourses I.24.1

THURSDAY The Quiet Courage of Routine

By Thursday, the novelty of solo parenting has worn off and what remains is the work: breakfast, school drop-off, rehearsal pickup, dinner, homework, bed. Marcus Aurelius knew this grind intimately. As emperor, his days were filled not with glory but with petitions, judgments, and correspondence — the unglamorous machinery of duty. He wrote: 'Waste no more time arguing what a good man should be. Be one.' There is a deep courage in simply doing the next right thing, hour after hour, without applause.

At the end of today, name three small duties you fulfilled well. Not achievements — duties. The lunch you packed. The question you answered patiently. The drive you made without complaint.

"Waste no more time arguing what a good man should be. Be one." — Marcus Aurelius, Meditations X.16

Reflections & Practice

FRIDAY The Night Before the Stage

Tomorrow, Elsie performs. Tonight, the butterflies arrive. The Stoics distinguished between the things we control and the things we don't. Elsie cannot control whether the audience laughs at the right moments or whether she forgets a line. She can control whether she walks on stage with her chin up and her heart open. Epictetus taught his students that the practice itself is the preparation: 'What should a philosopher say in the face of each of the hardships of life? It was for this that I have been training myself; it was for this that I was practising.' Every rehearsal this week was not just learning lines — it was building the muscle of showing up. Dan, your job tonight is simple: be the calm in her storm. Don't fix her nerves. Just sit with them.

Elsie: What is the bravest thing about being on stage? Dan: What did you learn about yourself this week as a solo parent?

"What should a philosopher say, then, in the face of each of the hardships of life? It was for this that I have been training myself; it was for this that I was practising." — Epictetus, Discourses III.10.7

SATURDAY Play Your Part Admirably

Laura returns. Elsie takes the stage. The family is whole again, gathered in a darkened auditorium to watch their youngest do something brave. This is the moment Epictetus was talking about: not the choosing of the role, but the playing of it — admirably, fully, without holding back. Elsie will stand under the lights and become someone else for a little while, which is really the most human thing there is. Dan, you held the fort. Laura, you came back. The Stoics would say: this is what virtue looks like in practice. Not a grand philosophical declaration, but a family reunited on a Saturday evening, watching their daughter shine. Marcus Aurelius wrote that we should think of ourselves as having already lived our life, and now take what's left and live it properly. Today, live it properly. Cheer loudly. Hug tightly. Be here.

After the play, share one moment from this week when you felt most like yourself. What role were you playing when it happened?

"Think of yourself as dead. You have lived your life. Now take what's left and live it properly." — Marcus Aurelius, Meditations II.5

Practice Together

The Role Card Game

At Sunday dinner, give each family member three index cards. On each card, write one role you play in the family (examples: chef, joke-teller, dog-walker, homework helper, morning person, worry-carrier). Lay all the cards on the table. Now each person picks up one card that belongs to someone else — a role they'd like to try this week, even once. Dan might pick up Laura's 'bedtime story reader.' Elsie might pick up Dan's 'breakfast maker.' Discuss: What does it feel like to imagine yourself in someone else's role? What would you need to do it well?

Epictetus taught that we are actors in a play we didn't write. This exercise makes that metaphor tangible — it shows the family that roles are not fixed identities but parts we can learn, practice, and share.

The Bravest Part of the Play

Elsie, think about your character in the play. Your character has to do brave things on stage — say lines in front of people, stand in the spotlight, keep going even if something goes wrong. But here's the secret: you're already doing something braver than your character. You're the one who shows up to rehearsal every day. You're the one who memorized the lines. You're the one who will walk out on that stage on Saturday, heart pounding, and do it anyway. A really old philosopher named Epictetus said that we're all actors in a play. He didn't mean we're pretending — he meant that life gives us parts to play, and the bravest thing we can do is play our part with everything we've got. What's the bravest part of your play this week — on stage or off?

The Stoics believed that courage isn't the absence of fear — it's doing the thing even when you're scared. Every time you walk on stage with butterflies in your stomach, you're practicing the oldest kind of bravery there is.

You did not choose every role life handed you this week — the solo parent, the traveler, the performer. But you played them. And in the playing, you discovered something the Stoics knew two thousand years ago: virtue is not a thing you have. It is a thing you do, one scene at a time.

The Weekly Read

4 articles clipped · Themes, reflections, and something fun

The Convergence Engine

Both of these tools solve the same fundamental problem: making sense of chaos at scale. World Monitor triangulates geopolitical truth from 190+ data sources, physical signals, and a convergence algorithm that surfaces reality when multiple independent signals point the same direction. OpenAI's data agent triangulates analytical truth from code lineage, query history, metadata, and institutional memory stored in Slack threads and Google Docs. Both share a philosophy that Bellingcat pioneered a decade ago—that the name literally means ‘belling the cat,’ doing the dangerous thing no one else will—which is that truth emerges not from any single authoritative source but from the convergence of many independent ones. The uncomfortable question neither article addresses: both systems explicitly remove humans from the verification loop. Habib says ‘zero editorializing.’ OpenAI says ‘shifting iteration from the user into the agent itself.’ When does the convergence engine become so trusted that we stop asking whether the signals it’s missing are the ones that matter most?

How a Music Streaming CEO Built an Open-Source Global Threat Map in His Spare Time *(tech, osint, geopolitics)*

A streaming CEO's weekend project became the world's go-to wartime dashboard—and he did it by treating geopolitics like a music catalog.

Inside Our In-House Data Agent *(ai, data, engineering)*

OpenAI built an AI agent to navigate its own 600-petabyte data labyrinth—and the most revealing part is what it still gets wrong.

When Values Have a Price Tag

Strip away the rhetoric and both stories are about the same thing: the gap between what institutions say they value and where they actually send the money. FCPS invokes ‘equity’ while its budget reveals a system that prioritizes administrative comfort over classroom outcomes. Nvidia talks ‘ecosystem strategy’ while its investment behavior reveals a company backing away from ethical complexity it didn’t sign up for. Anthropic says no to military AI and gets punished by the government but rewarded by users. OpenAI says yes to the Pentagon and gets the contract but loses the App Store. What’s striking is how fast the sorting is happening. Families aren’t writing letters to the school board—they’re enrolling in private school. Consumers aren’t writing op-eds about AI ethics—they’re switching apps. MIT Sloan’s Michael Cusumano called Nvidia’s original OpenAI investment ‘kind of a wash.’ Maybe. But the wash is getting muddier by the week, and the people watching are getting better at reading the current.

The Downfall of Fairfax County Public Schools *(education, local, policy)*

FCPS spends \$22,644 per student and delivers 25:1 class sizes. Private schools charge \$19,391 and deliver 10:1. The math speaks for itself.

Jensen Huang Says Nvidia Is Pulling Back from OpenAI and Anthropic *(ai, business, ethics)*

Nvidia is quietly exiting investments in both AI giants—and the ‘IPO window’ excuse doesn’t survive contact with reality.

The Through-Line: *The through-line this week is deceptively simple: convergence reveals truth. In the first cluster, it's literal—algorithms triangulating reality from hundreds of data streams. In the second, it's behavioral—thousands of individual decisions (enrollments, downloads, investment exits) converging into a signal no press release can drown out. The real question for the dinner table: when you see a gap between what someone says and what they do, how many signals do you need before you trust the pattern?*

And Finally...

Here's a dinner table reversal for you: some cats are allergic to humans. Yes, really. Just like people can be allergic to cat dander, cats can develop allergies to human skin flakes, perfumes, and even laundry detergent residue on clothes. Symptoms include sneezing, watery eyes, and itchy skin—which means your cat's inexplicable sneezing fits might not be a hairball situation. Veterinary dermatologists estimate that about 1 in 200 cats has some form of human-related allergy. So the next time someone says 'I'm allergic to cats,' you can tell them the feeling might be mutual.

Source: *Mental Floss*

4 articles · March 2 – March 8, 2026

Bedtime Story

The Case of the Midnight Helpers

The Case of the Midnight Helpers

It started with a pencil.

On Monday morning, Chelsie opened her desk and found her favorite mechanical pencil — the green one with the tiny shark sticker — sitting right on top of her notebook. She hadn't seen it in three weeks. She'd assumed it was gone forever, swallowed by the gap between the radiator and the wall.

"That's weird," she whispered to Sharkie, who rode in her backpack for exactly these situations. She looked around. Nobody was watching. Nobody was smiling like they'd done something nice. It was just... there.

On Tuesday, Maya's hair clip appeared on her cubby hook. On Wednesday, three overdue library cards materialized on Mrs. Patterson's desk. And every morning, Chelsie noticed the same strange thing — a faint trail of tiny scratches along the baseboards, so small you'd miss them unless you were the noticing kind.

Chelsie was the noticing kind.

"I think someone is sneaking into the school at night," she told Daddio at dinner. He was serving broccoli and rice, and the kitchen smelled like curry.

"A burglar who returns things?" Daddio raised an eyebrow. "That's a new one."

"Maybe it's a ghost," Chelsie said, half-serious.

"Maybe," Daddio said. "Or maybe it's someone who's been there all along and you just haven't looked in the right place yet."

That bugged her all through Thursday. During play rehearsal, while the other kids ran lines on stage, Chelsie sat in the wings and made a list in her notebook:

CLUES:

1. Lost things returning to the right desks (someone knows which kid sits where)
2. Tiny scratches near the floor (too small for shoes)
3. Always happens overnight
4. No one has seen anything

She added a fourth line, then crossed it out, then wrote it again: Who knows every room in the school better than anyone?

After rehearsal, most kids spilled out the front doors into the warm spring evening. Chelsie told Daddio she'd forgotten something and slipped back inside. The hallways were different after hours — quieter, longer, the sunset making orange rectangles on the tile floor. She heard humming coming from classroom 204.

She crept to the doorway and peered in.

Mrs. Rosie, the school janitor — silver braids, rubber-soled shoes, and a mop that moved like she was slow-dancing with it — was kneeling beside the low bookshelf near the window. She set down two tiny dishes, no bigger than bottle caps. One held a crumble of cheddar cheese. The other, three peanut halves.

"There you go," Mrs. Rosie said, soft as a lullaby. "You've earned it tonight."

Three small mice emerged from behind the bookshelf — one brown, one gray, one with a white patch on its ear. They went straight for the cheese and peanuts, nibbling with their tiny paws curled around the pieces.

The white-eared mouse pushed something forward with its nose. A silver bracelet.

"Oh, beautiful," Mrs. Rosie whispered, picking it up. "The girl in room 206 has been looking for this." She placed it carefully in her apron pocket. "You three are better than any lost-and-found box, you know that?"

Chelsie's shoe squeaked on the tile.

Mrs. Rosie looked up — not startled, just warm, like she'd been expecting company eventually. "Chelsie. I had a feeling you'd be the one to figure it out."

"You trained them?" Chelsie stepped inside, eyes wide.

"Trained is a strong word. We have an arrangement." Mrs. Rosie wrung out her mop. "They squeeze into the places I can't reach — under radiators, behind bookshelves, inside desk gaps. They find what falls through the cracks. I put it back where it belongs. And I make sure they get a good supper for their trouble."

"Cheese and peanuts," Chelsie said, kneeling down. The gray mouse looked up at her, whiskers twitching, then went back to its peanut.

"Their favorites." Mrs. Rosie smiled. "You know what I love about this work? Every night I make this place a little bit better for the morning. Nobody notices a clean floor. But the kids walk on it. Nobody sees a found bracelet appear — they just feel lucky. That's enough for me."

"It shouldn't have to be," Chelsie said quietly.

Mrs. Rosie stopped mopping. She looked at Chelsie for a long moment. "No," she said. "I suppose it shouldn't."

They sat together while the mice finished their supper. Outside, a power company truck rumbled past — linemen heading out to fix something the spring storm knocked loose, climbing poles in the rain so that the lights in this very classroom would turn on tomorrow morning.

"Mrs. Rosie," Chelsie said, "how many people like you are out there? People who fix things nobody sees?"

"More than you'd think, sweetheart. The cooks who start before dawn so lunch is warm. The crossing guard who stands in the cold. The linemen up on those poles right now." She paused. "Most of them don't get cheese and peanuts, either."

Walking home, the streetlights flickered on one by one above them — each one a small gift from someone whose name they'd never know. Chelsie squeezed Sharkie tight against her chest.

"Daddio," she said, "I figured out the mystery."

"Yeah?"

"The world is full of midnight helpers. And I think most of them have never been thanked."

Daddio took her hand. "Then I think you know what to do next."

The next morning, Chelsie arrived early. She left a note on the janitor's cart, folded into a tiny square:

Dear Mrs. Rosie — I notice. Thank you. — Chelsie

P.S. I left extra peanuts in your desk drawer. Please share with your team.

Who are the people at your school that you might not always notice — but who make your day better? | If you could leave a thank-you note for someone who works behind the scenes, who would it be and what would you say? | Why do you think Mrs. Rosie said "that's enough for me" — and why did Chelsie say "it shouldn't have to be"?

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